results if you try ISO 400 or above and only look good if you take really, really small printouts. After all the technological advancement, the rule of thumb still stands — more often than not, lower ISO settings will usually lead to photos with less noise.

Selecting an ISO Speed

A camera is usually the most sensitive at values like 400, 800 or 1600 — depending on the one you've got. This is the coolest setting for taking pictures indoors with no fears of ending up with blurred pics. But you will find the images a little 'grainier' — although it'll look okay on the LCD display at the back. If you select ISO 200, the camera will function more normally — perfect for indoor photos (with a flash, of course) and fine for daylight scenes yielding smoother pictures. The lowest speeds found on standard compact cameras are typically, 50, 64 and 100. These are meant for long exposures or large apertures to get better pictures (nights would be a better time to try this one out).

Conclusion

So, as you can see by now, you can't understand apertures, shutters or ISO speeds in isolation, because they are all interrelated and help you get the optimal exposure for that perfect picture. But these are just the basics. There are many more features that cameras provide, which, once you learn to use them, would make you a better photographer. But that calls for another chapter, so read on.